

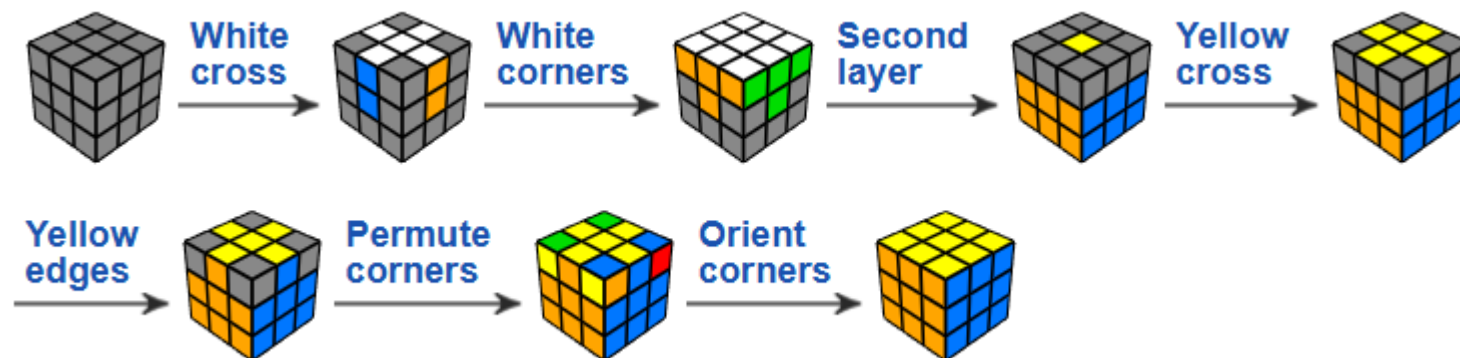


DSA103 Advanced Chemical Data Science

Lecture 2: Computational Thinking
(with Python)

Prof. Meredith C. Schuman

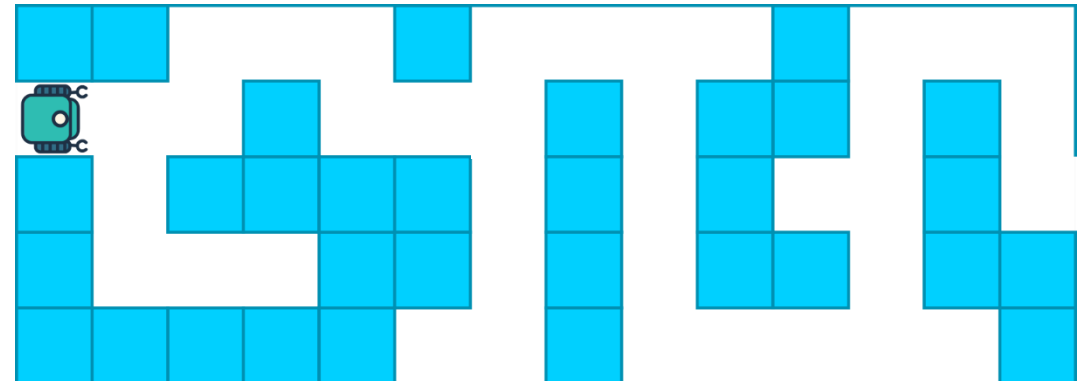
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Discussion of homework

Swap your pseudocode with your neighbor and be each other's "robots"! Afterwards, we will discuss together.

As the robot, does the pseudocode make you smart enough to solve the maze?
If so, how?
If not, why not?



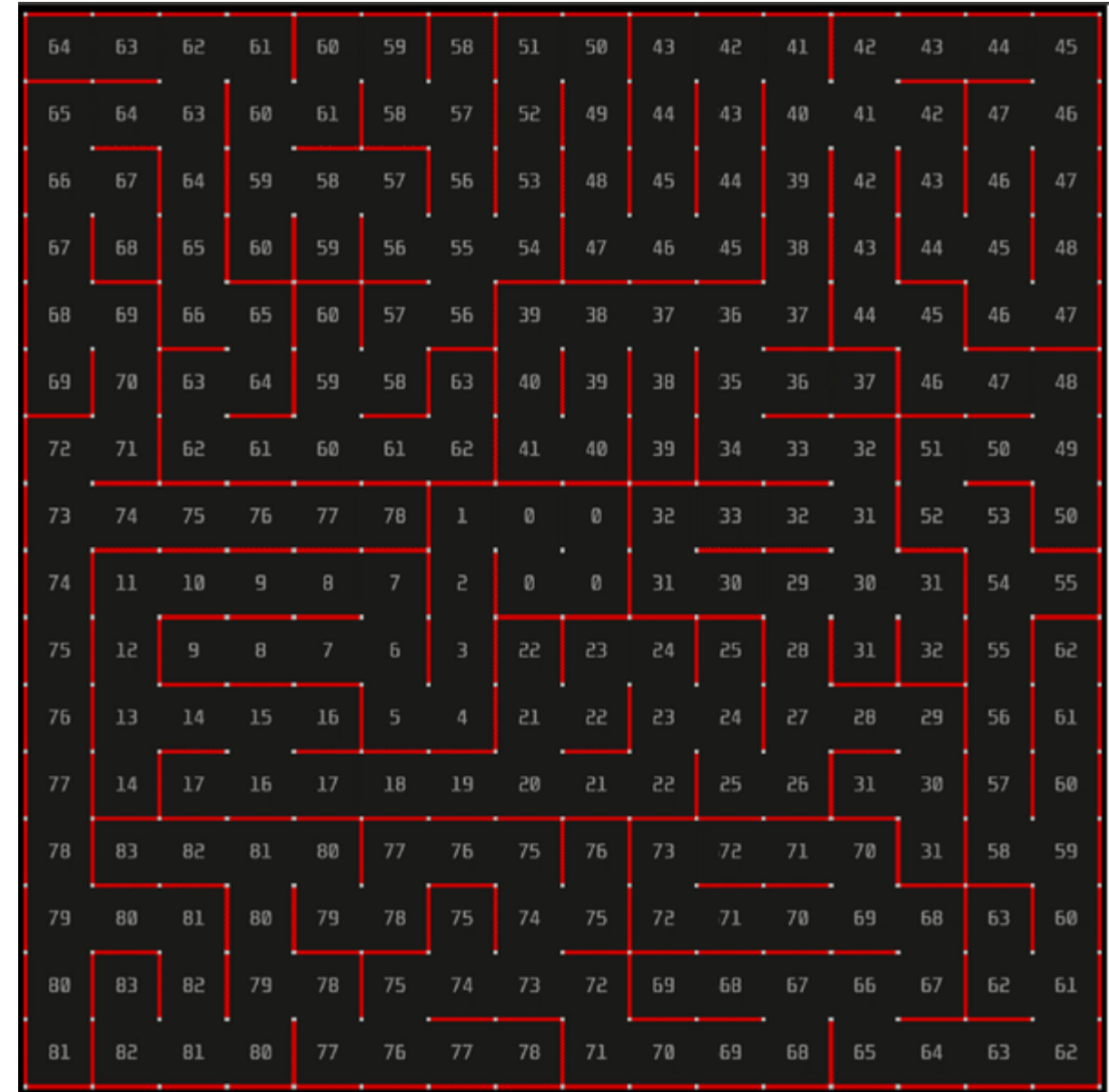
A solution

The wall follower...

- might not find the exit under all conditions, mazes
- definitely won't find the optimal solution

Finding the optimal solution is a complete branch of computer science.

See e.g. Generating and Solving a Perfect Maze (With Algorithms)



<https://github.com/darshit-desai/Maze-Solver-simulation-using-Wall-Following-Algorithm-OOP>

From pseudocode to real code to Python

To grasp a high-level problem, we used simplified language and pseudocode:

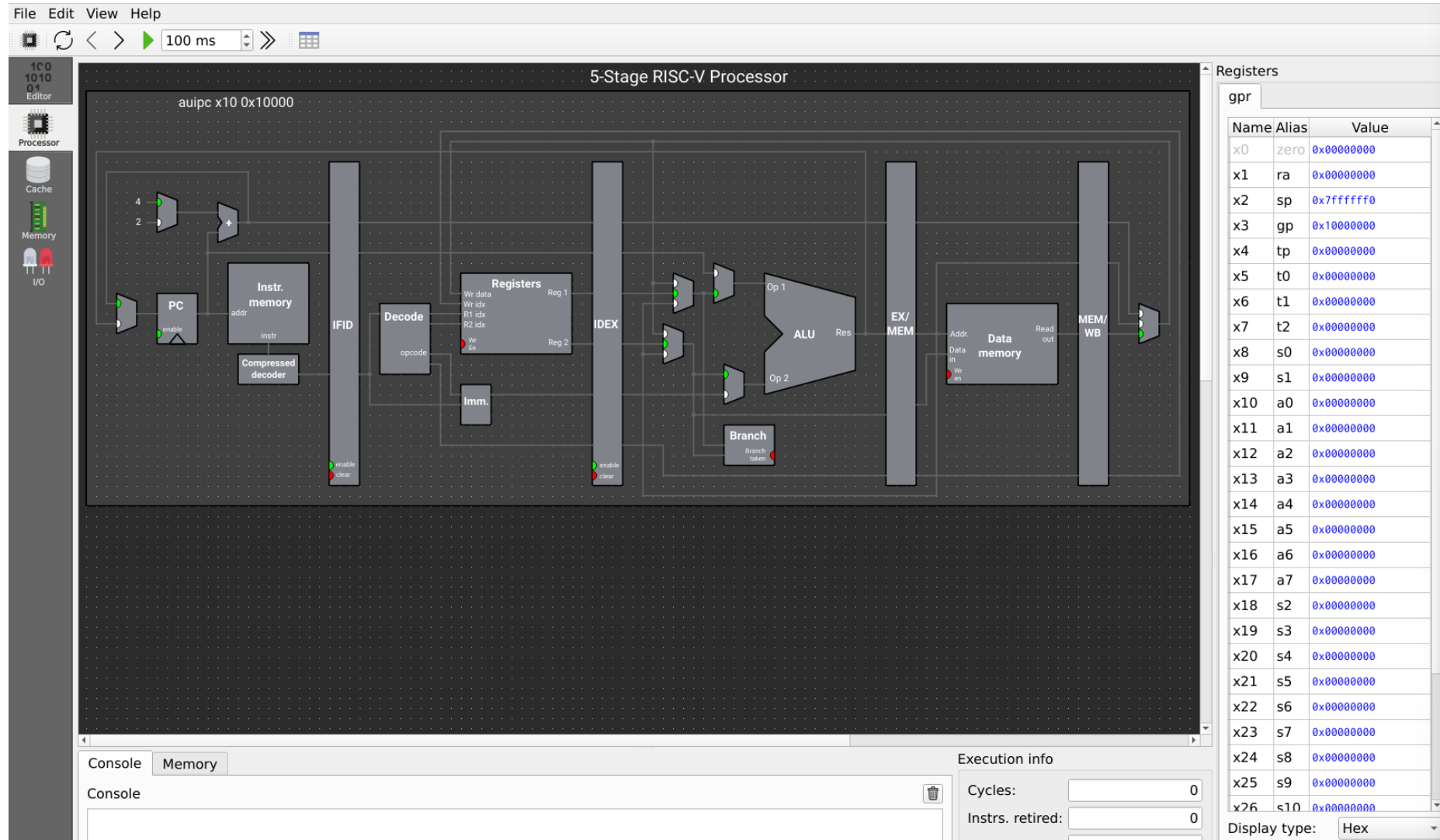
```
function rotate_left
```

```
    rotate_clockwise; rotate_clockwise; rotate_clockwise
```



Internally, the machine executing our instructions operates on a much lower level.

From pseudocode to real code to Python



From pseudocode to real code to Python

The screenshot shows the RISC-V IDE interface. The top menu bar includes File, Edit, View, and Help. The 'File' menu is open, showing options like New Program (Ctrl+N), Load Program (Ctrl+O), Load Example... (with a submenu), Save File (Ctrl+S), Save File As..., and Exit. The 'Load Example...' submenu is open, listing examples: Assembly (complexMul.s, consolePrinting.s, consoleReading.s, factorial.s, leds.s), C, and ELF (precompiled C).

The main window is split into two panes. The left pane, titled 'Source code', shows assembly code for a program that demonstrates string, integer, and float printing. The right pane, titled 'View mode', shows the binary representation of the code, with 'Input type' set to 'Assembly' and 'View mode' set to 'Binary'.

Source code:

```
1 # This example demonstrates how strings, integers, chars and floating point
2 # values may be printed to the console
3
4 .data
5 str:      .string      "A string"
6 newline:  .string      "\n"
7 delimiter: .string      ", "
8
9 .text
10 # ----- String printing -----
11 la a0, str # Load the address of the string, placed in the static data
12 li a7, 4   # Argument '4' for ecall instructs ecall to print to console
13 ecall
14
15 jal printNewline
16
17 # ----- Integer printing -----
18 # Print numbers in the range [-10:10]
19 li a0, -10
20 li a1, 10
21 li a2, 1
22 jal loopPrint
23
24 jal printNewline
25
26 # ----- Float printing -----
27 # Print an approximation of Pi (3.14159265359)
```

Binary view:

Address	Hex	Binary	Comment
0:	10000517	00010000000000000000000010100010111	IF
4:	00050513	000000000000000000000000101000010100010011	
8:	00400893	000000000000000000000000100010010011	
c:	00000073	001110011	
10:	040000ef	00000100000000000000000000000000000000000011101111	
14:	ff600513	11111111011000000000000010100010011	
18:	00a00593	00000000101000000000000010110010011	
1c:	00100613	00000000000010000000000011000010011	
20:	044000ef	00000100010000000000000000000000000000000011101111	
24:	02c000ef	00000010110000000000000000000000000000000011101111	
28:	40491537	01000000010010010001010100110111	
2c:	fdb50513	11111101101101010000010100010011	
30:	00200893	000000000000000000000000100010010011	
34:	00000073	001110011	
38:	018000ef	00000001100000000000000000000000000000000011101111	
3c:	02100513	00000010000100000000000010100010011	
40:	03500593	00000011010100000000000010110010011	
44:	00b00613	00000000101100000000000011000010011	
48:	01c000ef	00000001110000000000000000000000000000000011101111	
4c:	048000ef	00000100100000000000000000000000000000000011101111	
00000050 <printNewline>:			
50:	10000517	00010000000000000000000000000000000000000010100010111	
54:	fb950513	11111011100101010000010100010011	
58:	00400893	000000000000000000000000100010010011	
5c:	00000073	001110011	
60:	000000ef	001100111	

From pseudocode to real code to Python

Source code

Input type: ☒ Assembly ☐ Executable code

View mode: ☒ Binary ☐ Disassembled

```
1 # This example demonstrates how strings, integers, chars and floating point
2 # values may be printed to the console
3
4 .data
5 str:      .string      "A string"
6 newline:  .string      "\n"
7 delimiter: .string      ", "
8
9 .text
10 # ----- String printing -----
11     la a0, str # Load the address of the string, placed in the static data
12     li a7, 4  # Argument '4' for ecall instructs ecall to print to console
13     ecall
14
15     jal printNewline
16
17 # ----- Integer printing -----
18 # Print numbers in the range [-10:10]
19     li a0, -10
20     li a1, 10
21     li a2, 1
22     jal loopPrint
23
24     jal printNewline
25
26 # ----- Float printing -----
27 # Print an approximation of Pi (3.14159265359)
28     li a0, 0x40490FDB
29     li a7, 2
30     ecall
31
32     jal printNewline
33
34 # ----- ASCII character printing -----
35 # Print ASCII characters in the range [33:53]
36     li a0, 33
```

0:	10000517	0001000000000000000010100010111
4:	00050513	00000000000001010000010100010011
8:	00400893	00000000010000000000100010010011
c:	00000073	0000000000000000000000000110011
10:	040000ef	000001000000000000000000011101111
14:	ff600513	1111111011000000000010100010011
18:	00a00593	00000000101000000000010110010011
1c:	00100613	00000000000100000000011000010011
20:	044000ef	000001000100000000000000011101111
24:	02c000ef	00000010110000000000000001101111
28:	40491537	01000000010010010001010100110111
2c:	fdb50513	11111101101101010000010100010011
30:	00200893	000000000100000000000000010010011
34:	00000073	00000000000000000000000001110011
38:	018000ef	000000011000000000000000011101111
3c:	02100513	0000010000100000000010100010011
40:	03500593	00000011010100000000010110010011
44:	00b00613	0000000101100000000011000010011
48:	01c000ef	000000011100000000000000011101111
4c:	048000ef	000001001000000000000000011101111
00000050 <printNewline>:		
50:	10000517	00010000000000000000010100010111
54:	fb950513	11111011100101010000010100010011
58:	00400893	00000000010000000000100010010011
5c:	00000073	00000000000000000000000001110011
60:	00008067	00000000000000000100000001100111
00000064 <loopPrint>:		
64:	00050293	00000000000001010000001010010011
68:	00058313	00000000000001011000001100010011
0000006c <loop>:		
6c:	00028513	000000000000000101000010100010011
70:	00060893	00000000000001100000100010010011
74:	00000073	00000000000000000000000001110011

gpr

Name	Alias	Value
x0	zero	0x00000000
x1	ra	0x00000000
x2	sp	0x7fffffff0
x3	gp	0x10000000
x4	tp	0x00000000
x5	t0	0x00000000
x6	t1	0x00000000
x7	t2	0x00000000
x8	s0	0x00000000
x9	s1	0x00000000
x10	a0	0x10000000
x11	a1	0x00000000
x12	a2	0x00000000
x13	a3	0x00000000
x14	a4	0x00000000
x15	a5	0x00000000
x16	a6	0x00000000
x17	a7	0x00000004

Console

Memory

Console

Printing "A string" in Python

Every higher-level language is executing machine instructions in the end (including Python).

A string

(After 7 steps)

```
print("A string")
```

From pseudocode to real code to Python

Syntax, Semantics, Types

We define a certain structure so that it is easier to read by humans and uniquely defines what the computer will execute and calculate.

Syntax

Semantics

Types

Often, but not always, a mix of English and mathematics:

```
a = 2
b = 3
f = a + b
f is 5
```

```
if (a > b)
```

```
while (condition)
```

Exercises on GitHub

Please fork and clone the repository by Friday. Come with any questions!

(See README; you'll need a free GitHub account.)

[Link to helpful GitHub tutorials](https://github.com/mcschuman/ChemicalDataScience103)

<https://github.com/mcschuman/ChemicalDataScience103>

The screenshot shows the GitHub repository page for 'ChemicalDataScience103'. At the top, the repository name is displayed with a 'Public' badge. Below this, there are buttons for 'main' (selected), '1 Branch', and '0 Tags'. A search bar labeled 'Go to file' is present, along with 'Add file' and 'Code' buttons. The commit history shows a single commit by 'mcschuman' titled 'chore: initial commit' with hash '624ecf0' and timestamp '14 minutes ago'. Below the commit, a list of files is shown: 'assignments', 'lectures', '.gitignore', 'README.md', 'pyproject.toml', and 'uv.lock', each with its commit hash and timestamp. The 'README' file is selected, showing its content. The README title is 'DSA103'. The content describes the repository for the course 'DSA103 Advanced Chemical Data Science', lists the instructors (Prof. Meredith C. Schuman and Dr. Johannes Schörghöner) with their email addresses, and mentions the teaching assistant (Dimitrios Xynos) with his email address. The section 'Prerequisites' is also visible at the bottom.

ChemicalDataScience103 Public

main 1 Branch 0 Tags

Go to file T Add file <> Code

mcschuman chore: initial commit 624ecf0 · 14 minutes ago 2 Commits

assignments	chore: initial commit	14 minutes ago
lectures	chore: initial commit	14 minutes ago
.gitignore	started	32 minutes ago
README.md	chore: initial commit	14 minutes ago
pyproject.toml	chore: initial commit	14 minutes ago
uv.lock	chore: initial commit	14 minutes ago

README

DSA103

Repository for the course DSA103 Advanced Chemical Data Science. All course material will be shared here, whereas OLAT will only be used for all course-related communication.

Instructors and persons responsible for the course: Prof. Meredith C. Schuman (meredithchristine.schuman@uzh.ch), Dr. Johannes Schörghöner (johannes.schoergenhuemer@chem.uzh.ch)

Teaching assistant: Dimitrios Xynos (dimitrios.xynos@chem.uzh.ch)

Prerequisites

Concepts we will need for the exercises

What is a string?

Data type

Sequence of characters enclosed in quotes

What can you do with a string?

Iterate (loop)

Identify the nature of the characters (e.g. letter, number)

Index

Slice

Alter contents

Convert to a different type

What is a regular expression (Regex)?

Sequence of characters specifying a matching pattern in strings

Regular expressions are not required for these exercises but may make for easier solutions.

Requires `import re` in Python

Use <https://regex101.com/> to design RegEx

Exercise 1: Molecular Formula Parser

Objective: Write a function `parse_molecular_formula(formula)` that counts atoms in molecular formulas. Start with the simple cases, but design your solution to handle increasingly complex inputs without major rewrites.

Think computationally: How can you break this problem into smaller, reusable pieces that won't need to be completely rewritten when the requirements change?

```
# Simple single-letter elements, single-digit counts
test_cases_level1 = [
    ("H2O", {"H": 2, "O": 1}),
    ("CH4", {"C": 1, "H": 4}),
    ("CO2", {"C": 1, "O": 2}),
    ("NH3", {"N": 1, "H": 3})
]
```

```
# Two-letter elements like Ca, Cl, Na
test_cases_level2 = [
    ("NaCl", {"Na": 1, "Cl": 1}),
    ("CaCl2", {"Ca": 1, "Cl": 2}),
    ("MgO", {"Mg": 1, "O": 1}),
    ("AlCl3", {"Al": 1, "Cl": 3}),
    ("H2SO4", {"H": 2, "S": 1, "O": 4})
]
```

```
# Multi-digit counts
test_cases_level3 = [
    ("C12H22O11", {"C": 12, "H": 22, "O": 11}), # Sucrose
    ("Ca10P6O26", {"Ca": 10, "P": 6, "O": 26}), # Hydroxyapatite
    ("C2H5OH", {"C": 2, "H": 6, "O": 1}),       # Ethanol
    ("Fe2O3", {"Fe": 2, "O": 3})               # Iron oxide
]
```

Exercise 2: Chemical Equation Balancer Checker

Objective: Write a program that checks if a chemical equation is balanced.

Problem: Create a function called `is_balanced()` that takes a chemical equation string and returns True if balanced, False if not.

Your Task:

- Split the equation at the arrow symbol "→" to get reactants and products
- For each side, parse the molecules and their coefficients
- Count total atoms of each element on both sides
- Compare the totals

Example Equation Format: "2H₂ + O₂ → 2H₂O"

Exercise 3: Reaction Pathway Analyzer

Objective: Analyze multi-step reaction sequences to find synthesis pathways.

Problem: Write a program that determines what compounds can be synthesized from starting materials through a series of reactions, and finds a pathway to create a target compound.

Your Task: Create a function called `find_synthesis_path()` that takes:

- A list of starting compounds
- A list of reaction equations
- A target compound to synthesize

The function should return either:

- A list of reaction steps that lead to the target compound, OR
- A message saying the target cannot be synthesized

Let's try!

Your assignment is in session02_assignment. Show your reasoning in comments and/or Markdown fields.

What you don't finish today in class will be **homework**. Ask questions and help each other.

Next session (Wednesday), please raise questions that came up while attempting the homework.

We will discuss solutions in class next Friday. The **homework must be submitted by 7:59 next Friday**.

Submit homework to dimitrios.xynos@chem.uzh.ch, subject "DSA103_26_Ex1_LastName_FirstName".

